

SALES TRAINING DEBRIEF · SESSION 9

Integrity Holds Water. Give the 1%. Get the 200%.

Session led by Corie Dawson, Director

Tuesday 19 May 2026 · Internal sales-team summary

The thesis in one line

Wednesday's session was scripts. Today's session was integrity. Every script in this toolkit only works if the operator running it has integrity — meaning when you say something, you do it. The team's current pattern is to receive instructions, agree out loud, and then quietly not deliver. That gap is where the money lives. Close the gap.

"You're 99% good and 1% the part that's holding you back. Give me the 1% and I'll give you the 200%. Or hold the 1%, and you're costing yourself the 200% — for the rest of your career." — Corie (paraphrased)

1. The visionary-directions metaphor

Corie opened the session with a metaphor for the dynamic he's been navigating with the team. He sees the destination (income, lifestyle, career level) and is giving the team turn-by-turn directions to get there. The team has been receiving the directions, nodding, and then ignoring them.

"If I give you directions to my house — go straight, turn left, two kilometres past the service station — and you don't follow them, you don't end up at my house. That's not my fault. That's the directions, working exactly as designed." — Corie (paraphrased)

What this means for the team

Every coaching session is a set of directions. The reps who follow them arrive at the destination. The reps who second-guess, half-follow, or quietly ignore the directions don't arrive — and then look around confused that the destination hasn't come to them. The first job this week is to be honest about which mode you've been operating in.

2. The three pillars — what they actually mean

Honesty, integrity, loyalty. The words come up across multiple sessions. This session was the deepest definition yet of what each one means in practice — and where each one breaks.

The pillar	What it means in practice
HONESTY	Telling yourself the truth about your effort.

The pillar	What it means in practice
	Saying things you actually believe. Staying silent when you should speak is also dishonesty.
INTEGRITY	Cleanliness of conversation. When you say something, you do it. The glass holds water. No leaks between the saying and the doing.
LOYALTY	Backing the people who back you — especially when it costs you something. Loyalty is only tested when there's an opportunity to be disloyal.

When integrity gets tested

Integrity is only ever tested in moments where you have the option not to deliver. The test isn't whether you said the right thing — it's whether you closed the gap between saying and doing. Saying yes and not doing = low integrity. Saying "that's great" when it isn't = low integrity. Going silent when the right move would be to speak = low integrity.

"Integrity is cleanliness of conversation. It's clean — there's no guessing around it. This glass has integrity because it holds water. When dealing with you, I feel like the glass leaks." — Corie

3. The glass-with-holes diagnostic

A clean self-check Corie used multiple times in the session: imagine your integrity is a glass. Every time you say something and don't do it, you punch another hole in the glass. The water — meaning trust, momentum, money, opportunity — just leaks out across the table.

Where the holes typically are

- "I'll read the book this weekend." → didn't.
- "I'll have it done by Tuesday." → still on the to-do list Friday.
- "I'll follow up with that prospect today." → forgot until next week.
- "I'll change that habit starting Monday." → Monday came and went.
- "I'm disciplined / focused / committed." → behaviour doesn't match the words.

The exercise

Once a week — Friday afternoon or Sunday morning — list every commitment you made the previous week. Mark each one delivered, partially delivered, or undelivered. The undelivered list IS your holes. Count them. Patch them. The goal isn't zero — humans miss things. The goal is that you can see them, name them, and care enough to fix them.

"Water just goes everywhere, all over the table. No integrity. The glass doesn't hold the water. That's what dealing with you feels like — and you can fix it. But

not by arguing about whether the glass is leaking. By patching the holes.” — Corie (paraphrased)

4. The A / B / C choice model

A simple framework Corie introduced for how reps process incoming instruction. There are only three response patterns. The reps who run out of pattern A get the career. The ones who default to B or C don't.

The three modes

Mode	What it looks like
MODE A	Listen → get it done. No internal monologue, no excuse-loading, no negotiating with the instruction. Just delivery.
MODE B	Listen → make excuses. You heard it. You agree it's the right move. But you've already started building the reason it won't happen for you specifically.
MODE C	Check out. The instruction goes in one ear and out the other. You don't even register it consciously enough to argue with it.

What the leader is doing in response

Corie has his own A/B/C in parallel. He gives instructions nicely first (his Mode A). When that doesn't land, he escalates the harshness (his Mode B). If even that fails, he checks out (his Mode C — quietly redirecting attention to someone who responds). The reps who notice the leader's mode shifting and don't fix their own pattern end up at Mode C — which is invisible, terminal, and impossible to recover from once it's been activated.

“You think I'm being harsh because I've shifted into hard-talk mode. I've shifted into hard-talk mode because nothing in nice mode landed. The trajectory of your career is the trajectory of how often you're running Mode A vs Mode B vs Mode C.” — Corie (paraphrased)

5. The plateau diagnosis — moving sideways is the worst state

A confronting frame. The team isn't regressing. Three years ago there were patterns being broken. Today, those patterns are gone — but the next set of patterns hasn't been built. The team is performing significantly better than where they started, and significantly worse than where they could be. They're grinding sideways.

“I can't stand it when it goes sideways. Up I sell. Down I buy. Sideways tells me nothing. The Bitcoin chart is sideways. The team chart is sideways. Same problem.” — Corie (paraphrased)

Why sideways is worse than regression

- Regression triggers urgency. You see the line going down, you act.
- Sideways looks fine. You can rationalise it as "stable," "consolidating," "maintaining."
- Time keeps passing but the position doesn't change. Six months later you're still here.
- Compounding works against you — the people not sideways are pulling further ahead while you stay still.

How to break sideways

Look at the last month where the line went meaningfully up. What habits were running? Reverse-engineer them. Restart them. This is the same recovery protocol from Session 5 — and the same answer here. Sideways breaks when habits restart, not when the market changes or the team rotates.

6. The Sunday principle — sacred reflection time

A specific habit Corie returned to throughout the session. Sundays are for reflection — not for recovery from going out, not for catching up on chores, not for social plans. Sunday is the day you think about the week.

The framing

Corie reserves his Sundays explicitly. No visitors. No errands. No commitments. Even family is asked to schedule around it. The hours are spent thinking — about what worked last week, what needs to change next week, what bigger move is coming.

"Sunday is a 'do not disturb' zone. It's an opportunity to think about how good Monday is going to be — and the rest of the week. Most people use Sunday to recover from Friday and Saturday. That's the difference." — Corie (paraphrased)

The practical version for the team

- Block Sunday morning (or whichever 2–3 hour window is yours) as non-negotiable.
- No screens. No calls. A notebook and a coffee.
- Three questions to answer in writing: What worked last week? What didn't? What's the one thing I'll change this week?
- Identify the pattern audit — what worked at your last peak that isn't running now?
- Carry the answers into Monday morning. Don't walk into Monday cold.

The reps who keep this ritual have a structural advantage over those who don't — every Monday they start with clarity that everyone else won't have until Wednesday.

7. Complacency is cancer — it spreads invisibly

Returning theme. Complacency doesn't announce itself. You don't wake up complacent — you drift there one small comfort at a time. The dangerous thing about complacency is how reasonable each individual step feels.

How complacency builds, step by step

- You used to prep on Sunday. Now sometimes you don't. (Reasonable — you're tired.)
- You used to take 1:30 standup seriously. Now you join with one eye on your phone. (Reasonable — busy day.)
- You used to read the book. Now you'll get to it later. (Reasonable — life got in the way.)
- You used to call back the day you said you would. Now sometimes you push it 24 hours. (Reasonable — emergencies.)
- All five together = a fundamentally different rep than the one you were. But you've seen them as individual reasonable concessions.

“Complacency is cancer. By the time you can feel it, the damage is done. The fix has to be catching it before you can feel it — when each individual concession is still small enough to reverse.” — Corie (paraphrased)

8. The soup test — what does your daily behaviour taste like?

A vivid metaphor from the session. If your daily behaviour was distilled into a soup and served to your team, what would it taste like? Bitter? Sour? Off? Or rich, warm, full of flavour — making people want a second bowl?

What the soup is made of

- **How you greet the morning.** Energetic and engaged — or grumpy and silent?
- **How you respond to a request.** "On it" — or a sigh and a delay?
- **How you treat people who can't help you.** Same as people who can — or worse?
- **How you receive correction.** Curious — or defensive?
- **How you talk about absent colleagues.** Generously — or critically?

Every one of these is an ingredient. Tasted over a week, your team is making a judgment about whether they want more of you or less. Nobody tells you the soup is off. They just start spitting it out — by avoiding you, by going around you, by quietly looking elsewhere.

“When they taste the soup, it should be: wow, full of flavour, beautiful, I want more. That's how you should want to be perceived. Especially if you're trying to grow your career and your team.” — Corie (paraphrased)

9. Inherited patterns vs chosen patterns

A confronting and carefully handled segment of the session. The patterns we operate with weren't chosen by us — they were inherited from the people who raised us, taught us, and surrounded us. That's not blame; it's diagnosis.

The distinction that matters

Inheriting a pattern isn't a moral failing. Continuing it once you've recognised it IS a choice. Whatever family, mentor, coach, or culture shaped you, the patterns came along. The work is to look at each pattern honestly and decide: does this serve me now, or am I just running it because it's familiar?

"You can't help where you came from. But you can choose what you bring into your life. Once you can see the pattern, continuing it is on you." — Corie (paraphrased)

The audit

- What patterns do you run when stressed — and where did they come from?
- What patterns do you run when celebrating — and where did they come from?
- What patterns do you run when correcting someone — and where did they come from?
- Which of those serve you today? Which are running on autopilot for no reason?

This isn't therapy. It's engineering. You're looking at the source code of your behaviour and identifying which lines should stay and which should be rewritten.

10. Sniffing the baseline — diagnosing absent colleagues

A practical tool Corie introduced midway through. Whenever a colleague's baseline shifts noticeably — abnormally cheerful, abnormally quiet, abnormally sick, abnormally unavailable — pay attention. The shift itself is the signal that something is going on.

What to do with the signal

- Don't take their stated reason at face value, especially if they've given the same reason multiple times.
- Don't assume the worst — but don't assume nothing either.
- Open a door. "Hey, you OK? I noticed you've been quieter than usual. Anything going on?"
- If they don't open up, bring it to the leadership team. Better to over-care than miss something.
- A good manager identifies the shift and surfaces it. A weak manager waits for the issue to break visibly before responding.

"I sniff out weakness — too sad, weak, depressed, OR too happy. All roads lead to depression. When someone disrupts their own baseline, something is happening. Notice it." — Corie (paraphrased)

11. The 1% / 200% trade

The closing frame of the session. Corie's observation about the team: they're 99% good. The 1% they're holding onto — the ego, the excuse, the unread book, the missed Sunday — is the part that's costing 200% in upside.

"You're 99% good and that 1% is the part that's holding you back. Let go of the 1% — give me the 1% — and I'll give you the 200%. Or hold the 1% and watch what it costs you for the next decade." — Corie (paraphrased)

What the 1% looks like for most reps

- The pride that won't let you say "I haven't actually read it."
- The defensiveness that argues when correction lands.
- The small social commitment that crowds out the Sunday reflection.
- The "I'll process it" that becomes "I'll forget it."
- The inherited pattern you can see clearly but won't commit to changing.

Each is small in isolation. Together they're the whole gap between where you are and where you could be. Identify yours. Give it up. Watch the 200% arrive.

12. Behaviours to change this week

1. **Run a Friday integrity audit.** List every commitment you made this week. Mark each delivered, partial, or missed. Look at the missed list. Patch the holes.
2. **Move to Mode A on every incoming instruction.** Listen, then act. No internal monologue. No excuse-loading. If you genuinely disagree, say so out loud — not in your head, three days later.
3. **Reclaim Sunday.** Two to three hours. No screens. Three questions in a notebook: what worked, what didn't, what changes this week.
4. **Identify one inherited pattern that doesn't serve you.** Write down where it came from and why it's still running. Decide deliberately whether to keep it.
5. **Spot one colleague's baseline shift this week.** Then open the door. "You OK? Anything going on?" Don't wait for things to break visibly.
6. **Identify your 1%.** What's the one thing you're holding onto that's costing the most? Pick it. Drop it. Watch what happens.
7. **Pattern audit — what changed since your last peak month?** Write the list. The thing that broke isn't the team. It's the routine. Restart it.

Final reminder. This session was light on tactics on purpose. Tactics live in the toolkits from Sessions 1–8. This session was about the operator running them. Every script in those toolkits assumes integrity — saying something and doing it — and most of the gap between where you are and where you could be is in that one variable. Give the 1%. Get the 200%.